



# Dramatic Elements - Macbeth

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1.

★  
DEFINE
2.

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MODEL
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YOUR TURN

## Define



### Scene Description

Two students sit side by side in a classroom. They talk directly into the camera.

### Transcript

00:00 (INTRODUCTION PLAYS)

00:05 REBECCA: The way a play appears on a page is like a code.

00:09 CHRISTINA: Mmm, like...html?

00:11 REBECCA: Yeah! Html is a code that a web designer

00:14 gives the computer to help visualize the website.

00:17 CHRISTINA: And dramatic elements tells us readers how to visualize a play.

00:29 Which is why the plays look like that.

00:31 REBECCA: Like what? CHRISTINA: Like a code!

00:33 REBECCA: They do? CHRISTINA: Hey, that was your analogy.

00:36 Oh, those line breaks everywhere.

00:37 Uhh, Christina, Rebecca, Christina, Rebecca.

00:41 REBECCA: I am so smart.

00:42 CHRISTINA: Some stuff are in italics and other stuff are all in caps.

00:45 REBECCA: Hold up. Sometimes italics mean stage direction.

00:49 Like, "enter Macbeth and a servant with a torch."

00:52 But other times, it means setting: "a cavern.

00:55 In the middle: a boiling cauldron."

00:57 CHRISTINA: Yikes. Those three witches, always hated that part.

01:01 But, anyway, yeah.

01:02 Because different publishers will print plays differently,

01:05 so you gotta take a few minutes to learn the code before you start reading.

01:09 REBECCA: How about all those parentheses before a line of dialogue?

01:13 CHRISTINA: Hmm, well parentheses usually indicate actions

01:16 or emotional directions to the actors: sad, annoyed, or bored.

01:21 REBECCA: Good to know, because as readers all these features

01:24 are going to let us know what's happening in the scene.

01:33 CHRISTINA: So, in order to understand what the playwright

01:35 is trying to get across...

01:36 REBECCA: You gotta crack the code.

01:38 CHRISTINA: Cause dramatic elements are there to give actors and directors

01:41 instructions on how to perform.

01:43 REBECCA: And us readers instructions on how to read the play.

01:46 CHRISTINA: So, should we summarize?

An *element* is a building block, an ingredient, one part that makes up a whole. A dramatic element is something that contributes to the play, one of several building blocks that make it effective. These elements include setting, character, plot, and theme, as well as stage directions and dialogue. The way a playwright introduces each of these elements into a drama, and connects them so that one has an effect on another, is what can make a play memorable. The setting, or the time and place in which the action occurs, can affect the events of the plot, which in turn can have an effect on the characters and their relationship to one another. This can influence the conflict the characters face and, as a consequence, shape the theme.